

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1137

By Seal

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Chief Freddie Joe Devotie of Jefferson City.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to recognize those exemplary citizens whose lives of service and sacrifice have profoundly impacted their communities and the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Freddie Joe Devotie, born on October 16, 1944, was one such individual, whose distinguished career in the fire service spanned thirty-eight years, a tenure marked by unwavering dedication, leadership, and a deep commitment to the protection of life and property; and

WHEREAS, in 1986, Chief Devotie reorganized and founded the Lakeway Central Volunteer Fire Department; he faithfully served the Lakeway Central Volunteer Fire Department, including more than three decades as Fire Chief, during which time he helped shape the department into a respected and capable organization that has served Jefferson County and the surrounding region with honor; and

WHEREAS, throughout his tenure, Chief Devotie exemplified the highest standards of the fire service, mentoring countless firefighters, instilling discipline, and fostering a culture of professionalism, integrity, and brotherhood that will endure for generations; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his service as a firefighter, Chief Devotie was the devoted pastor of House of Prayer in Morristown for twenty-five years, faithfully ministering to his congregation and serving as a spiritual leader within the community; and

WHEREAS, known as a man of conviction, strong character, and unwavering faith, Chief Devotie led both in word and deed, always speaking truth and guiding others with wisdom and purpose; and

WHEREAS, Joe Devotie put God first in everything he did, and his primary goal in death was to kiss and wash the feet of Jesus; and

WHEREAS, his legacy is not only reflected in the department he helped build but in the lives of those he mentored, the community he served, and the family he loved; and

WHEREAS, Joe Devotie is survived by his children, Tim (Kim) Devotie, Steve (Pam) Devotie, Lisa Devotie, and Josh (Misty) Devotie; grandchildren, Rusty, T.J., Tanner (Chalea), Eli (Lauren), Trinity (Jonathan), Derrick (Amber), Jacob, Layla, and Weston; great-grandchildren, Samuel, Trenton, Ella, Emmy, and Walker; and a host of nieces, nephews, and other special family and friends; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by his wife, Judy Kay Devotie; granddaughter, Taylor Devotie; parents, George and Ethel Devotie; and siblings, James, Charlie, Floyd, Paul, David, Scottie "Ed," Ruby, Rosie, Ruth, Gladys, Dolly, Lula-Belle, Dorothy, and two infant siblings; and

WHEREAS, Chief Devotie's passing leaves a profound void in the Jefferson County community, the fire service, and the State of Tennessee, but his legacy of service, sacrifice, and leadership will continue to inspire all who follow in his footsteps; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Chief Freddie Joe Devotie for his extraordinary life of service and extend our deepest sympathy to his family, friends, and the members of the Lakeway Central Volunteer Fire Department.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.

